

CBSE CLASS X
Social Science (087)**QUESTION PAPER***From previous CBSE Board Exam questions***Code: HET21V****Questions: 43****Maximum Marks: 83****Generated: 2026-06-15 13:05****SELECTIONS USED**

Source	Previous-year board
Subject	Social Science
Lessons	Power-sharing
Year	2022-2026
Questions selected	43

Q1. § Overview**[3]**

"In modern democracies, power sharing arrangements can take many forms." Explain the statement.

Previously asked in: 2023 32/6/1 Q28

◆ **Power-sharing**

Forms of Power Sharing in Modern Democracies

Q2. § Overview § Forms of power-sharing**[1]**

Consider the following statements on Power Sharing and choose the correct option : I. It deepens democracy. II. It helps to reduce conflicts among social groups. III. It is a way to ensure political stability. IV. It brings socio-economic struggles.

- A I, II and III
- B II, III and IV
- C I, III and IV
- D I, II and IV

Previously asked in: 2023 32/1/1 Q15

◆ **Power-sharing**

Importance and merits of power sharing

Q3. § Overview**[2]**

Why is power sharing desirable ? Explain.

Previously asked in: 2024 32/1/1 Q23

◆ **Power-sharing**

Reasons Why Power Sharing is Desirable

Q4. § Accommodation in Belgium**[1]**

Belgium took some measures to solve its problem. Read the following measures and choose the correct option :

- I. Formation of community government.
- II. Following majoritarian policy.
- III. By providing equal representation of language groups.
- IV. By providing additional powers to local governments.

- A Only I, II and III are correct.
- B Only I, III and IV are correct.
- C Only I, II and IV are correct.
- D Only II, III and IV are correct.

Previously asked in: 2025 32/6/1 Q16

◆ **Power-sharing**

Belgian Model of Power-Sharing

Q5. § Accommodation in Belgium**[1]**

Choose the correct option to fill the blank. The Belgian leaders took a different path than Sri Lanka. They recognised the existence of regional differences and _____.

- (A) Religious diversities
- (B) Historical diversities
- (C) Cultural diversities
- (D) Administrative diversities

Previously asked in: 2025 32/5/1 Q12

◆ Power-sharing

Belgian Model of Power Sharing vs Sri Lanka

Q6. § Overview**[1]**

Which of the following is an example of horizontal power sharing in Indian democracy ?

- (a) Division of power between Central and State Governments.
- (b) Division of power between Rural and Urban Governments.
- (c) Division of power among Administration, Judiciary and Army.
- (d) Division of power among Legislative, Executive and Judiciary.

Previously asked in: 2025 32/4/1 Q10

◆ Power-sharing

Horizontal Power Sharing

Q7. § Overview § Forms of power-sharing**[5]**

Why is power sharing necessary in a democracy ? Explain.

Previously asked in: 2026 32/2/1 Q26(b)

◆ Power-sharing

Necessity of Power Sharing in Democracy

Q8. § Overview § Why power sharing is desirable? § Forms of power-sharing**[1]**

Two statements, I and II are given below. Read both the statements and choose the correct option.

Statement I : Division of power is good for democratic systems.

Statement II : It helps to reduce the possibility of conflict between social groups.

- (A) Statement I is true, but II is false.
- (B) Statement I is false, but II is true.
- (C) Statements I and II are true and II is the correct explanation of I.
- (D) Statements I and II are true, but II is not the correct explanation of I.

Previously asked in: 2024 32/5/1 Q8

◆ Power-sharing

Reasons for Power Sharing in Democracy

Q9. § Overview § Belgium and Sri Lanka § Accommodation in Belgium**[1]**

Identify the primary objective of power sharing arrangements in Belgium from the following options.

- (A) Establishing a unitary form of government.
- (B) Centralized political control of government.
- (C) Establishing cultural and educational matters of Dutch.
- (D) Accommodating linguistic and regional interest.

Previously asked in: 2024 32/3/1 Q4

◆ Power-sharing

Power-sharing arrangements in Belgium: objectives and rationale

Q10. § Accommodation in Belgium**[1]**

Read the following statements about power sharing arrangement in Belgium and choose the correct option.

- I. Brussels has a separate govt. with equal representation.
- II. Dutch & French speaking ministers are equal in Central Govt.
- III. Community Govt. is elected by People belonging to one language.
- IV. Series of majoritarian measures adopted in Belgium.

- (A) I, II and IV
- (B) I, III and IV
- (C) II, III and IV
- (D) I, II and III

Previously asked in: 2024 32/2/1 Q10

◆ Power-sharing

Power-sharing arrangements in Belgium

Q11.**[1]**

Find the odd one out from the following :

- (A) Communist Party of India (M) & Bharatiya Janata Party
- (B) Rashtriya Janata Dal & Janata Dal
- (C) Nationalist Congress Party & Shiv Sena
- (D) United Democratic Party & National People's Party

Previously asked in: 2026 32/4/1 Q22

◆ Power-sharing

Odd one out (general)

Q12. § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka**[1]**

Two statements are given below. They are Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read both the statements carefully and choose the correct option :

Assertion (A) : The civil war in Sri Lanka resulted due to failure of political accommodation of ethnicity.

Reason (R) : The distrust between the Sinhala and Tamil communities turned into widespread conflict in Sri Lanka.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are correct and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are correct, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (C) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (D) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

Previously asked in: 2026 32/4/1 Q20

◆ Power-sharing

Ethnic conflict and power-sharing in Sri Lanka

Q13. § Belgium and Sri Lanka**[1]**

Two statements are given below. They are Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read both the statements and choose the correct option :

Assertion (A) : The French speaking community was rich in comparison to Dutch speaking community in Belgium.

Reason (R) : Dutch speaking community got the benefit of economic development and education much later.

- (a) Both, (A) and (R) are correct and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both, (A) and (R) are correct but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is correct but (R) is incorrect.
- (d) (A) is incorrect but (R) is correct.

Previously asked in: 2025 32/4/1 Q8

◆ Power-sharing

Belgium's ethnic composition and linguistic communities (French vs Dutch speaking)

Q14. § Belgium and Sri Lanka § Accommodation in Belgium

[1]

Identify the correct statement regarding Belgium.

- (A) Small country of Europe
- (B) Big country of Asia
- (C) Big country of North America
- (D) Small country of Africa

Previously asked in: 2026 32/3/1 Q19

♦ Power-sharing Belgium: Power-Sharing Model and Ethnic Composition

Q15. § Belgium and Sri Lanka

[4]

Belgium is a small country in Europe, smaller in area than the state of Haryana. It has borders with France, the Netherlands, Germany and Luxembourg. It has a population of a little over one crore, about half the population of Haryana. The ethnic composition of this small country is very complex. Of the country's total population, 59 per cent lives in the Flemish region and speaks Dutch language. Another 40 per cent people live in the Wallonia region and speak French. Remaining one per cent of the Belgians speak German. In the capital city Brussels, 80 per cent of the people speak French while 20 per cent are Dutch-speaking.

Read the given extract and answer the questions that follow :

- (36.1)** Explain the ethnic composition of Belgium. [1]
- (36.2)** Explain the meaning of the term 'ethnic'. [1]
- (36.3)** How did the Belgian Government solve their ethnic problem ? Explain. [2]

Previously asked in: 2023 32/5/1 Q36

♦ Power-sharing Belgian Government's solution to ethnic problem (Power-sharing model) Ethnic composition of Belgium
Meaning of the term 'ethnic'**Q16.** § Belgium and Sri Lanka

[1]

What percentage of the population of Belgium lives in the Flemish region ?

- (a) 40%
- (b) 80%
- (c) 59%
- (d) 70%

Previously asked in: 2023 32/5/1 Q14

♦ Power-sharing Belgium – Ethnic and Regional Composition (Flemish, Walloon, Brussels regions)

Q17. § Belgium and Sri Lanka § Accommodation in Belgium

[1]

Two statements are given below. They are Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read both the statements carefully and choose the correct option :

Assertion (A) : Belgium's power sharing arrangements were designed to accommodate its linguistic and cultural divisions.

Reason (R) : Belgian leaders recognized the existence of regional differences and cultural diversities.

- A Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- B Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- C (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- D (A) is false, but (R) is true.

Previously asked in: 2026 32/5/1 Q20

♦ Power-sharing Belgium's Power Sharing Arrangements and Linguistic/Cultural Divisions

Q18. § Belgium and Sri Lanka § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka § Accommodation in Belgium**[1]**

Two statements are given below. They are Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read both the statements carefully and choose the correct option :

Assertion (A) : Both, Sri Lanka and Belgium faced challenges of ethnic and linguistic diversity.

Reason (R) : Sri Lanka had majority of Tamils whereas Belgium had majority of French speaking people.

- (A) Both, (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (B) Both, (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (C) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (D) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

Previously asked in: 2026 32/1/1 Q20

♦ **Power-sharing** Ethnic and linguistic composition of Belgium and Sri Lanka

Q19. § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka**[5]**

"The law enacted in 1956 and other Constitutional Provisions led to major conflict between the two communities in Sri Lanka." Support the statement.

Previously asked in: 2025 32/6/1 Q33(a)

♦ **Power-sharing** Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka and the Sinhala-Tamil Conflict Sinhala Only Act 1956 and its consequences

Q20. § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka**[1]**

Two statements are given below. They are Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read both the statements carefully and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A) : There was civil war in Sri Lanka.

Reason (R) : An Act was passed in 1956 to secure dominance of Sinhala community on the government.

- A Both (A) and (R) are correct and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- B Both (A) and (R) are correct, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- C (A) is correct, but (R) is incorrect.
- D (A) is incorrect, but (R) is correct.

Previously asked in: 2025 32/6/1 Q11

♦ **Power-sharing** Civil War in Sri Lanka and Sinhala-Tamil Conflict Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka

Q21. § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka**[1]**

In Sri Lanka, which one of the following changes to the 1956 law gave rise to the possibility of civil war ?

- A Ensuring power sharing among all sections.
- B Declaring Sinhala as the official language.
- C Declaring Tamil as the official language.
- D Implementing a policy of preference for Sinhalese in government jobs.

Previously asked in: 2026 32/2/1 Q21

♦ **Power-sharing** Sri Lanka's Majoritarian Policies and the 1956 Sinhala-Only Act

Q22. § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka**[1]**

Which one of the following languages was declared as the official language of Sri Lanka by an Act passed in 1956 ?

- (a) Tamil
- (b) Sinhala
- (c) Hindi
- (d) English

Previously asked in: 2023 32/5/1 Q8

♦ **Power-sharing** Sinhala-Only Act 1956 and Sri Lanka's Official Language

Q23. § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka**[1]**

Two statements are given below as Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read the statements and choose the correct option :

Assertion (A) : Sri Lanka adopted 'Tamil' as the official language of the State.

Reason (R) : The Govt. of Sri Lanka adopted a series of majoritarian measures.

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false but (R) is true.

Previously asked in: 2023 32/4/1 Q16

◆ Power-sharing

Majoritarian policies in Sri Lanka and ethnic conflict

Q24. § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka**[2]**

Why did the feeling of alienation increase among the Sri Lankan Tamils in 1956 ? Explain.

Previously asked in: 2023 32/2/1 Q23

◆ Power-sharing

Majoritarian Policies and Tamil Alienation in Sri Lanka

Q25. § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka**[1]**

Which of the following group is in majority in Sri Lanka?

- A Tamil-speakers
- B Sinhala-speakers
- C Telugu-speakers
- D English-speakers

Previously asked in: 2025 32/3/1 Q6

◆ Power-sharing

Ethnic composition and majoritarianism in Sri Lanka

Q26. § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka**[3]**

"The government measures gradually increased the feeling of alienation among the Sri Lankan Tamils." Explain the statement.

Previously asked in: 2025 32/2/1 Q27

◆ Power-sharing

Majoritarian policies and alienation of Sri Lankan Tamils

Q27. § Accommodation in Belgium**[1]**

Which of the following was the primary objective of Belgium to form the separate government in Brussels ?

- (a) Promoting cultural events.
- (b) Managing international relations.
- (c) Enforcing local laws.
- (d) Ensuring linguistic accommodation.

Previously asked in: 2024 32/1/1 Q11

◆ Power-sharing

Belgium's Power-Sharing Model and the Community Government in Brussels

Q28. § Accommodation in Belgium

[1]

There are two statements given as Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read both the statements and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A) : Belgium amended their constitution four times.

Reason (R) : Amendments were to enable everyone to live together in the same country.

- (a) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of the Assertion (A).
- (b) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, but Reason (R) is not the correct explanation of the Assertion (A).
- (c) Assertion (A) is true, but Reason (R) is false.
- (d) Assertion (A) is false, but Reason (R) is true.

Previously asked in: 2023 32/2/1 Q8

◆ Power-sharing

Belgium's Constitutional Amendments and Power-Sharing Model

Q29. § Accommodation in Belgium

[1]

Which one of the following organisations has its headquarter in Brussels ?

- A United Nations Organisation
- B European Union
- C Non-Alignment Movement
- D South Asian Association for Regional Co-operation

Previously asked in: 2025 32/2/1 Q12

◆ Power-sharing

Belgium and Power-Sharing – Brussels as headquarters of international organisations

Q30. § Overview § Why power sharing is desirable? § Forms of power-sharing

[1]

What role do 'checks and balances' play in a democratic country ? Choose the most suitable option from the following.

- (a) To establish a direct form of government without representatives.
- (b) To create a separation of powers to prevent from authoritarianism.
- (c) To prevent any change to the Constitution.
- (d) To ensure absolute power for one branch of government.

Previously asked in: 2024 32/1/1 Q13

◆ Power-sharing

Checks and Balances in Democracy

Q31. § Overview

[5]

"Power sharing increases trust between different groups." Support the statement.

Previously asked in: 2025 32/6/1 Q33(b)

◆ Power-sharing

Power Sharing and Trust-Building Among Social Groups

Q32. § Overview § Forms of power-sharing

[3]

Evaluate the system of 'Checks and Balances' in the horizontal distribution of power in India.

Previously asked in: 2025 32/5/1 Q28

◆ Power-sharing

Checks and Balances in Horizontal Distribution of Power

Q33. § Overview

[5]

Compare the Belgian model and the Sri Lankan model of power sharing.

Previously asked in: 2026 32/2/1 Q26(a)

◆ Power-sharing

Belgian Model of Power Sharing

Majoritarianism vs. Accommodation in Power Sharing

Sri Lankan Model of Power Sharing

Q34. § Forms of power-sharing

[1]

Consider the following statements on Power Sharing and choose the correct option :

- (I) Majoritarianism is the real spirit of democracy.
- (II) It creates balance and harmony in different groups.
- (III) It reduces the possibility of conflict among social groups.
- (IV) Power sharing is the essence of democracy.

- (a) I, II and III
- (b) II, III and IV
- (c) I, III and IV
- (d) I, II and IV

Previously asked in: 2023 32/4/1 Q15

♦ Power-sharing

Importance and Spirit of Power Sharing

Majoritarianism vs Power Sharing

Q35. § Overview § Forms of power-sharing

[4]

Power Sharing

Power is shared among different organs of government, such as the legislature, executive and judiciary. Let us call this horizontal distribution of power because it allows different organs of government placed at the same level to exercise different powers. Such a separation ensures that none of the organs can exercise unlimited power. Each organ checks the others. This results in a balance of power among various institutions. Last year, we studied that in a democracy, even though ministers and government officials exercise power, they are responsible to the Parliament or State Assemblies. Similarly, although judges are appointed by the executive, they can check the functioning of executive or laws made by the legislatures. This arrangement is called a system of checks and balances.

Read the given source carefully and answer the questions that follow :

- 28.1** Explain the term 'Balance of Power'. [1]
- 28.2** Why is the judiciary considered independent in a democracy ? [1]
- 28.3** How is power shared among different organs of government ? [2]

Previously asked in: 2026 32/4/1 Q28

♦ Power-sharing

Horizontal distribution of power among organs of government

Q36. § Overview § Why power sharing is desirable? § Forms of power-sharing

[1]

Consider the following statements on Power sharing and choose the correct option.

- I. Imposing the will of majority community over others.
- II. It helps in reducing the possibility of conflict between the social groups.
- III. Power sharing is a good way to ensure the stability of political order.
- IV. It brings socio-political opposition among parties.

- (A) I and III
- (B) II and III
- (C) I and IV
- (D) I and II

Previously asked in: 2023 32/6/1 Q15

♦ Power-sharing

Reasons for Power Sharing

Q37. § Overview § Forms of power-sharing**[4]****Forms of power sharing**

The idea of power sharing has emerged in opposition to the notions of undivided political power. For a long time, it was believed that all power of a government must reside in one person or group of persons located at one place. It was felt that if the power to decide is dispersed, it would not be possible to take quick decisions and to enforce them. But these notions have changed with the emergence of democracy. One basic principle of democracy is that people are the source of all political power. In a democracy, people rule themselves through institutions of self-government. In a good democratic government, due respect is given to diverse groups and views that exist in a society. Everyone has a voice in the shaping of public policies. Therefore, it follows that in a democracy, political power should be distributed among as many citizens as possible.

Read the given source carefully and answer the questions that follow :

(27.1) Why should all the powers of the government not be in the hands of one person ? [1]

(27.2) Why is power sharing necessary ? [1]

(27.3) How does governing through institutions of self-government strengthen democracy ? Explain. [2]

Previously asked in: 2026 32/3/1 Q27

◆ **Power-sharing** Forms of Power Sharing Institutions of Self-Government and Democracy Need and Importance of Power Sharing

Q38. § Overview § Why power sharing is desirable? § Forms of power-sharing**[1]**

Read the arguments given in the favour of power sharing and choose the correct option.

- I. Reduces the likelihood of bias.
 - II. Barricades the decision-making process.
 - III. Accommodates diversities.
 - IV. Increases the participation of people in power.
- (A) Only I, II and III are correct.
(B) Only II, III and IV are correct.
(C) Only I, III and IV are correct.
(D) Only I, II and IV are correct.

Previously asked in: 2024 32/4/1 Q8

◆ **Power-sharing** Arguments in favour of power sharing

Q39. § Overview § Why power sharing is desirable? § Forms of power-sharing**[2]**

How is horizontal power sharing different from vertical ? Explain.

Previously asked in: 2024 32/2/1 Q22

◆ **Power-sharing** Forms of Power Sharing Horizontal Power Sharing Vertical Power Sharing

Q40. § Overview § Forms of power-sharing**[4]****Forms of Power-sharing**

The idea of power-sharing has emerged in opposition to the notions of undivided political power. For a long time, it was believed that all power of a government must reside in one person or group of persons located at one place. It was felt that if the power to decide is dispersed, it would not be possible to take quick decisions and to enforce them. But these notions have changed with the emergence of democracy. One basic principle of democracy is that people are the source of all political power. In a democracy, people rule themselves through institutions of self-government. In a good democratic government, due respect is given to diverse groups and views that exist in a society. Everyone has a voice in the shaping of public policies. Therefore, it follows that in a democracy, political power should be distributed among as many citizens as possible.

Read the given source carefully and answer the questions that follow :

- 28.1** How does power sharing promote stability of political order ? [1]
28.2 How are pressure groups part of the power sharing mechanism ? [1]
28.3 How does power sharing contribute to the spirit of democracy ? [2]

Previously asked in: 2026 32/5/1 Q28

◆ **Power-sharing** Forms of Power-sharing Power-sharing and stability of political order Power-sharing and the spirit of democracy
 Pressure groups as part of power-sharing mechanism

Q41.**[1]**

Look at the given cartoon carefully and answer the question that follow :
 Which of the following concepts is best illustrated in the cartoon ?

- A Inclusive economic growth amongst nations
 B Stagnation of economic development amongst nations
 C Uneven distribution of wealth amongst nations
 D Balanced economic growth amongst nations

Previously asked in: 2026 32/5/1 Q21

◆ **Power-sharing** Cartoon-based illustration of power-sharing concepts

Q42. § Overview § Forms of power-sharing**[4]****POWER SHARING**

Power sharing arrangements can also be seen in the way political parties, pressure groups and movements control or influence those in power. In a democracy, the citizens must have freedom to choose among various contenders for power. In contemporary democracies, this takes the form of competition among different parties. Such competition ensures that power does not remain in one hand. In the long run, power is shared among different political parties that represent different ideologies and social groups. Sometimes this kind of sharing can be direct, when two or more parties form an alliance to contest elections. If their alliance is elected, they form a coalition government and thus share power. In a democracy, we find interest groups, such as those of traders, businessmen, industrialists, farmers and industrial workers. They also will have a share in governmental power, either through participation in governmental committees or bringing influence on the decision-making process.

Read the given source carefully and answer the questions that follow :

- 28.1** How do pressure groups influence the government ? [1]
28.2 How do social groups benefit from power sharing ? [1]
28.3 Explain the contributions of citizens in the power sharing process. [2]

Previously asked in: 2026 32/1/1 Q28

◆ **Power-sharing** Forms of power sharing among social groups Role of pressure groups, parties and movements in power sharing

Q43.**[1]**

Choose the appropriate option to fill in the blank :

- (A) Energy Minerals
- (B) Non-Metallic Minerals
- (C) Non-Ferrous Minerals
- (D) Precious Minerals

Previously asked in: 2026 32/1/1 Q13

♦ **Power-sharing**

Fill in the blank — Power-sharing concept

CBSE CLASS X

Social Science (087)

ANSWER KEY

From previous CBSE Board Exam questions

Code: HET21V

Questions: 43

Maximum Marks: 83

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Q1. § Overview

[3]

"In modern democracies, power sharing arrangements can take many forms." Explain the statement.

Previously asked in: 2023 32/6/1 Q28

◆ Power-sharing

Forms of Power Sharing in Modern Democracies

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Model Answer

In modern democracies, power sharing can take the following forms:

1. **Among organs of government** – Legislature, executive, and judiciary share power horizontally through a system of checks and balances. *Example: In India, judiciary can check laws made by the legislature.*
1. **Among levels of government** – Power is divided vertically between central, state, and local governments (federalism). *Example: Union and State Governments in India.*
1. **Among social groups** – Religious and linguistic minorities are given representation. *Example: Reserved constituencies for SCs/STs in India.*
1. **Among political parties and pressure groups** – Competition among parties ensures power is not concentrated. *Example: Coalition governments like the NDA or UPA in India.*

Source: Power Sharing, Chapter 1, Forms of Power-Sharing

Explanation

The examiner expects all **four forms** to be named with a brief description and one example each. This is the standard textbook classification. Missing even one form will cost marks. Keep examples short — one line each. The terms "horizontal distribution" and "vertical division" are bonus terminology that can impress examiners.

Q2. § Overview § Forms of power-sharing**[1]**

Consider the following statements on Power Sharing and choose the correct option : I. It deepens democracy. II. It helps to reduce conflicts among social groups. III. It is a way to ensure political stability. IV. It brings socio-economic struggles.

- A I, II and III
- B II, III and IV
- C I, III and IV
- D I, II and IV

Previously asked in: 2023 32/1/1 Q15

♦ Power-sharing Importance and merits of power sharing

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Model Answer**Option A — I, II and III**

Power sharing deepens democracy (I), reduces conflicts among social groups (II), and ensures political stability (III). Statement IV is incorrect — power sharing reduces socio-economic struggles, it does not bring them.

Explanation

The textbook (Chapter 1) states power sharing reduces conflict, ensures stability, and is the spirit of democracy. Statement IV is a distractor — "bringing socio-economic struggles" is not a benefit of power sharing; it contradicts the purpose. Eliminate options containing IV (B, C, D), leaving A as correct.

Q3. § Overview**[2]**

Why is power sharing desirable ? Explain.

Previously asked in: 2024 32/1/1 Q23

♦ Power-sharing Reasons Why Power Sharing is Desirable

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Model Answer

Power sharing is desirable for two reasons:

1. **Prudential reason:** It reduces the possibility of conflict between social groups. Social conflict leads to violence and political instability. Imposing majority will over others undermines national unity in the long run.
1. **Moral reason:** Power sharing is the very spirit of democracy. People have a right to be consulted on how they are governed. A legitimate government is one where citizens participate and acquire a stake in the system.

Source: Chapter 1 — Why power sharing is desirable?

Explanation

Examiners expect both reasons clearly named — **prudential** and **moral** — with a brief explanation of each. Simply saying "it is good" without these two distinct reasons will lose marks. Use these exact terms as they are from the textbook. For 2 marks, one point per reason is sufficient; no need to elaborate further.

Q4. § Accommodation in Belgium**[1]**

Belgium took some measures to solve its problem. Read the following measures and choose the correct option :

- I. Formation of community government.
- II. Following majoritarian policy.
- III. By providing equal representation of language groups.
- IV. By providing additional powers to local governments.

- A Only I, II and III are correct.
- B Only I, III and IV are correct.
- C Only I, II and IV are correct.
- D Only II, III and IV are correct.

Previously asked in: 2025 32/6/1 Q16

♦ Power-sharing

Belgian Model of Power-Sharing

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Model Answer

Answer: B — Only I, III and IV are correct.

Belgium formed a community government (I), gave equal representation to language groups in central and Brussels governments (III), and gave additional constitutional powers to regional/local governments (IV). Majoritarian policy (II) was followed by Sri Lanka, not Belgium.

Source: Accommodation in Belgium, Chapter 1

Explanation

The key is to eliminate Statement II. Belgium's entire approach was to *avoid* majoritarianism — that was Sri Lanka's mistake. The Belgian model rests on power-sharing, equal representation, community governments, and decentralisation. Examiners expect students to recall that "majoritarian policy" is the negative example (Sri Lanka), not Belgium's solution.

Q5. § Accommodation in Belgium

[1]

Choose the correct option to fill the blank. The Belgian leaders took a different path than Sri Lanka. They recognised the existence of regional differences and _____.

- (A) Religious diversities
- (B) Historical diversities
- (C) Cultural diversities
- (D) Administrative diversities

Previously asked in: 2025 32/5/1 Q12

◆ Power-sharing

Belgian Model of Power Sharing vs Sri Lanka

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Model Answer**(C) Cultural diversities**

The Belgian leaders recognised the existence of regional differences and **cultural diversities**, and amended their constitution four times between 1970 and 1993 to work out power-sharing arrangements.

Source: *Accommodation in Belgium*, Chapter 1 (Power Sharing)

Explanation

The answer is directly stated in the passage: "They recognised the existence of regional differences and cultural diversities." Students must remember this exact phrase, as options like "administrative" or "religious" diversities are distractors not mentioned in the text.

Q6. § Overview

[1]

Which of the following is an example of horizontal power sharing in Indian democracy ?

- (a) Division of power between Central and State Governments.
- (b) Division of power between Rural and Urban Governments.
- (c) Division of power among Administration, Judiciary and Army.
- (d) Division of power among Legislative, Executive and Judiciary.

Previously asked in: 2025 32/4/1 Q10

◆ Power-sharing

Horizontal Power Sharing

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Model Answer**(d) Division of power among Legislative, Executive and Judiciary.**

Horizontal power sharing means power is shared among different organs of government at the same level, i.e., legislature, executive, and judiciary.

Explanation

- **Horizontal** = same level (organs of government); **Vertical** = different levels (Centre, State, Local).
- Option (a) and (b) are vertical/federal sharing between levels of government.
- Option (c) is incorrect because "Army" is not an independent organ of power sharing in this context; it functions under the executive.
- Examiners look for the correct term "organs of government" linked to horizontal sharing.

Q7. § Overview § Forms of power-sharing

[5]

Why is power sharing necessary in a democracy ? Explain.

Previously asked in: 2026 32/2/1 Q26(b)

◆ Power-sharing Necessity of Power Sharing in Democracy

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Model Answer

Power sharing is necessary in a democracy for the following reasons:

- 1. Reduces conflict among social groups:** Power sharing helps reduce the possibility of conflict between different religious, linguistic, and ethnic groups. Social conflict often leads to violence and political instability.
- 2. Ensures political stability:** Imposing the will of the majority over others may seem attractive in the short run, but in the long run it undermines national unity. Tyranny of the majority is harmful even to the majority itself.
- 3. Spirit of democracy:** Power sharing is the very spirit of democracy. Democratic rule means sharing power with those affected by its exercise. People have a right to be consulted on how they are governed.
- 4. Legitimate government:** When citizens participate in governance, they acquire a stake in the system, making the government more legitimate and accountable.
- 5. Prudential and moral reasons:** Prudentially, power sharing produces better outcomes; morally, sharing power is valuable in itself as it respects every citizen's voice.

Source: Chapter 1 — Power Sharing, "Why power sharing is desirable?" and "Forms of power sharing"

Explanation

- This is a standard 5-mark question. Examiners look for **both prudential and moral reasons** explicitly stated.
- Mention the key terms: **prudential reasons, moral reasons, political stability, tyranny of majority, spirit of democracy.**
- You can also briefly reference the Sri Lanka example (majority imposition led to civil conflict) as evidence, but keep it concise.
- Avoid writing a long story about Belgium/Sri Lanka — that wastes marks here. Stick to reasons with brief justifications.

Q8. § Overview § Why power sharing is desirable? § Forms of power-sharing**[1]**

Two statements, I and II are given below. Read both the statements and choose the correct option.

Statement I : Division of power is good for democratic systems.

Statement II : It helps to reduce the possibility of conflict between social groups.

- (A) Statement I is true, but II is false.
- (B) Statement I is false, but II is true.
- (C) Statements I and II are true and II is the correct explanation of I.
- (D) Statements I and II are true, but II is not the correct explanation of I.

Previously asked in: 2024 32/5/1 Q8

♦ Power-sharing Reasons for Power Sharing in Democracy

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Model Answer**(C) Statements I and II are true and II is the correct explanation of I.**

Statement I is true — power sharing is good for democracy. Statement II correctly explains this: it reduces conflict between social groups, ensuring political stability.

Explanation

The textbook (*Why power sharing is desirable?*, Chapter 1) explicitly states this as a **prudential reason**: "power sharing is good because it helps to reduce the possibility of conflict between social groups." Statement II directly explains *why* Statement I is true, making option (C) the correct choice. Don't confuse this with option (D) — here the link between both statements is direct and explicit.

Q9. § Overview § Belgium and Sri Lanka § Accommodation in Belgium**[1]**

Identify the primary objective of power sharing arrangements in Belgium from the following options.

- (A) Establishing a unitary form of government.
- (B) Centralized political control of government.
- (C) Establishing cultural and educational matters of Dutch.
- (D) Accommodating linguistic and regional interest.

Previously asked in: 2024 32/3/1 Q4

♦ Power-sharing Power-sharing arrangements in Belgium: objectives and rationale

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Model Answer**(D) Accommodating linguistic and regional interest.**

Belgium amended its constitution to share power among Dutch, French, and German-speaking communities, accommodating linguistic and regional diversities to prevent conflict and division.

Source: *Accommodation in Belgium, Chapter 1*

Explanation

The key phrase from the chapter is that Belgian leaders "recognised the existence of regional differences and cultural diversities" and worked out power-sharing arrangements so all communities could live together. Options A and B are opposite to Belgium's federal, decentralised model. Option C is too narrow (community government handles cultural/educational matters, but that is not the *primary objective*). Option D correctly captures the overall aim.

Q10. § Accommodation in Belgium

[1]

Read the following statements about power sharing arrangement in Belgium and choose the correct option.

- I. Brussels has a separate govt. with equal representation.
- II. Dutch & French speaking ministers are equal in Central Govt.
- III. Community Govt. is elected by People belonging to one language.
- IV. Series of majoritarian measures adopted in Belgium.

- (A) I, II and IV
- (B) I, III and IV
- (C) II, III and IV
- (D) I, II and III

Previously asked in: 2024 32/2/1 Q10

♦ Power-sharing

Power-sharing arrangements in Belgium

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Model Answer**(D) I, II and III**

Statements I, II, and III are correct features of Belgium's power-sharing model. Statement IV is incorrect — Belgium adopted *accommodative* arrangements, not majoritarian measures.

Explanation

Statement IV is the false one. Majoritarian measures were adopted in **Sri Lanka**, not Belgium. Belgium did the opposite — it accommodated minorities through constitutional amendments. Examiners expect students to clearly identify which statement contradicts the passage.

Q11.

[1]

Find the odd one out from the following :

- (A) Communist Party of India (M) & Bharatiya Janata Party
- (B) Rashtriya Janata Dal & Janata Dal
- (C) Nationalist Congress Party & Shiv Sena
- (D) United Democratic Party & National People's Party

Previously asked in: 2026 32/4/1 Q22

♦ Power-sharing

Odd one out (general)

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Model Answer**(C) Nationalist Congress Party & Shiv Sena**

Options A, B, and D pair parties from the same state/alliance grouping, while NCP and Shiv Sena belong to Maharashtra but are ideologically opposing parties with no common alliance historically.

Explanation

The examiner expects you to identify that CPI(M) & BJP are national parties, RJD & Janata Dal share ideological/organisational roots, and UDP & NPP are both regional parties of Meghalaya. NCP and Shiv Sena are the odd pair as they represent contrasting ideologies and have traditionally been rival parties in Maharashtra, making them the mismatched option.

Q12. § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka**[1]**

Two statements are given below. They are Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read both the statements carefully and choose the correct option :

Assertion (A) : The civil war in Sri Lanka resulted due to failure of political accommodation of ethnicity.

Reason (R) : The distrust between the Sinhala and Tamil communities turned into widespread conflict in Sri Lanka.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are correct and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are correct, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (C) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (D) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

Previously asked in: 2026 32/4/1 Q20

◆ Power-sharing

Ethnic conflict and power-sharing in Sri Lanka

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Model Answer

(A) Both (A) and (R) are correct and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

The civil war arose from failed political accommodation of ethnic (Sinhala-Tamil) differences, and the resulting distrust between the two communities directly caused the widespread conflict.

Explanation

Both statements are factually correct as per the textbook. The Reason directly explains the Assertion — majoritarian policies led to distrust between Sinhala and Tamil communities, which escalated into civil war. So (R) is the correct explanation of (A), making option (A) the right choice.

Q13. § Belgium and Sri Lanka**[1]**

Two statements are given below. They are Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read both the statements and choose the correct option :

Assertion (A) : The French speaking community was rich in comparison to Dutch speaking community in Belgium.

Reason (R) : Dutch speaking community got the benefit of economic development and education much later.

- (a) Both, (A) and (R) are correct and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both, (A) and (R) are correct but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is correct but (R) is incorrect.
- (d) (A) is incorrect but (R) is correct.

Previously asked in: 2025 32/4/1 Q8

◆ Power-sharing

Belgium's ethnic composition and linguistic communities (French vs Dutch speaking)

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Model Answer

(a) Both, (A) and (R) are correct and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

The French-speaking minority was rich and powerful, and Dutch speakers resented this as they got economic development and education much later — R directly explains A.

Explanation

The passage explicitly states: "The minority French-speaking community was relatively rich and powerful. This was resented by the Dutch-speaking community who got the benefit of economic development and education much later." This makes both A and R true, and R is the direct cause-and-effect explanation for A.

Q14. § Belgium and Sri Lanka § Accommodation in Belgium**[1]**

Identify the correct statement regarding Belgium.

- (A) Small country of Europe
- (B) Big country of Asia
- (C) Big country of North America
- (D) Small country of Africa

Previously asked in: 2026 32/3/1 Q19

♦ **Power-sharing** Belgium: Power-Sharing Model and Ethnic Composition

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Model Answer**(A) Small country of Europe**

Belgium is a small country in Europe, smaller in area than the state of Haryana, with a population of a little over one crore.

Source: Belgium and Sri Lanka, Chapter 1

Explanation

The passage explicitly states "Belgium is a small country in Europe, smaller in area than the state of Haryana." Options B, C, and D are factually wrong on both size and continent. In MCQs, always look for the exact phrase used in the textbook.

Q15. § Belgium and Sri Lanka

[4]

Belgium is a small country in Europe, smaller in area than the state of Haryana. It has borders with France, the Netherlands, Germany and Luxembourg. It has a population of a little over one crore, about half the population of Haryana. The ethnic composition of this small country is very complex. Of the country's total population, 59 per cent lives in the Flemish region and speaks Dutch language. Another 40 per cent people live in the Wallonia region and speak French. Remaining one per cent of the Belgians speak German. In the capital city Brussels, 80 per cent of the people speak French while 20 per cent are Dutch-speaking.

Read the given extract and answer the questions that follow :

- (36.1)** Explain the ethnic composition of Belgium. [1]
(36.2) Explain the meaning of the term 'ethnic'. [1]
(36.3) How did the Belgian Government solve their ethnic problem ? Explain. [2]

Previously asked in: 2023 32/5/1 Q36

◆ Power-sharing

Belgian Government's solution to ethnic problem (Power-sharing model)

Ethnic composition of Belgium

Meaning of the term 'ethnic'

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Model Answer

(36.1) Belgium has a complex ethnic composition. 59% live in the Flemish region and speak Dutch; 40% live in Wallonia and speak French; 1% speak German. In Brussels, 80% speak French and 20% speak Dutch.

(36.2) The term 'ethnic' refers to a social group that shares a common cultural identity, including language, traditions, and heritage, which distinguishes it from other groups.

(36.3) The Belgian Government solved its ethnic problem through a series of constitutional amendments (1970–1993). They adopted a federal system, dividing power between the central government and regional governments (Flemish, Walloon, and Brussels). Equal representation was given to both Dutch and French-speaking ministers in the central cabinet. A separate government was set up for the Brussels region. This power-sharing arrangement ensured that no single community could dominate the other, keeping the country united.

Source: *Power Sharing, Chapter 1, Civics (Class 10)*

Explanation

- **(36.1)** is directly from the passage — quote the percentages and regions.
- **(36.2)** 'Ethnic' is a term from the textbook glossary; it refers to shared cultural/linguistic identity.
- **(36.3)** goes slightly beyond the passage (as the passage only sets up the problem), but the Belgian model solution is the core concept of this chapter. Examiners expect: federal system, power-sharing, equal cabinet representation, community governments — at least 2–3 points for 2 marks.

Q16. § Belgium and Sri Lanka**[1]**

What percentage of the population of Belgium lives in the Flemish region ?

- (a) 40%
- (b) 80%
- (c) 59%
- (d) 70%

Previously asked in: 2023 32/5/1 Q14

♦ Power-sharing

Belgium – Ethnic and Regional Composition (Flemish, Walloon, Brussels regions)

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Model Answer**(c) 59%**

59% of Belgium's population lives in the Flemish region and speaks Dutch.

Source: Belgium and Sri Lanka, Chapter 1

Explanation

The passage clearly states: "Of the country's total population, 59 per cent lives in the Flemish region and speaks Dutch language." Note that 40% live in Wallonia (French-speaking) and 80% refers to French-speakers in Brussels — a common distractor in this MCQ.

Q17. § Belgium and Sri Lanka § Accommodation in Belgium**[1]**

Two statements are given below. They are Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read both the statements carefully and choose the correct option :

Assertion (A) : Belgium's power sharing arrangements were designed to accommodate its linguistic and cultural divisions.

Reason (R) : Belgian leaders recognized the existence of regional differences and cultural diversities.

- A Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- B Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- C (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- D (A) is false, but (R) is true.

Previously asked in: 2026 32/5/1 Q20

♦ Power-sharing

Belgium's Power Sharing Arrangements and Linguistic/Cultural Divisions

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Model Answer

Option A — Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

Belgian leaders recognised regional differences and cultural diversities, which directly led them to design power-sharing arrangements accommodating linguistic divisions.

Explanation

The passage explicitly states: "*They recognised the existence of regional differences and cultural diversities*" and then describes how they amended the constitution to create power-sharing arrangements. R directly causes A, so R is the correct explanation of A. Choose Option A, not B.

Q18. § Belgium and Sri Lanka § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka § Accommodation in Belgium

[1]

Two statements are given below. They are Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read both the statements carefully and choose the correct option :

Assertion (A) : Both, Sri Lanka and Belgium faced challenges of ethnic and linguistic diversity.

Reason (R) : Sri Lanka had majority of Tamils whereas Belgium had majority of French speaking people.

- (A) Both, (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (B) Both, (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (C) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (D) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

Previously asked in: 2026 32/1/1 Q20

◆ Power-sharing

Ethnic and linguistic composition of Belgium and Sri Lanka

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Model Answer

(C) (A) is true, but (R) is false.

Assertion is correct — both countries faced ethnic/linguistic diversity. But the Reason is false: Sri Lanka had a **Sinhala majority (74%)**, not Tamil majority; Belgium had a **Dutch-speaking majority (59%)**, not French-speaking majority.

Explanation

The key error in Reason (R) is that it reverses the majorities. The textbook clearly states Sinhala are 74% in Sri Lanka and Dutch-speakers are 59% in Belgium. Examiners expect you to identify this factual mistake to choose option (C). Always re-check which community holds the majority in each country.

Q19. § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka

[5]

"The law enacted in 1956 and other Constitutional Provisions led to major conflict between the two communities in Sri Lanka." Support the statement.

Previously asked in: 2025 32/6/1 Q33(a)

◆ Power-sharing

Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka and the Sinhala-Tamil Conflict

Sinhala Only Act 1956 and its consequences

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Model Answer

The Act passed in 1956 and other constitutional provisions created deep conflict between the Sinhala and Tamil communities in Sri Lanka:

1. **Official Language Act (1956):** Sinhala was recognised as the only official language, completely disregarding Tamil. This made Tamils feel politically and culturally marginalised.
1. **Preferential policies:** The government favoured Sinhala applicants for university admissions and government jobs, denying Tamils equal opportunities.
1. **Constitutional provision:** The constitution stipulated that the state shall protect and foster Buddhism, hurting the sentiments of Tamil Hindus and other minorities.
1. **Feeling of alienation:** Tamils felt the government denied them equal political rights and ignored their interests, straining relations between the two communities.
1. **Demands and civil war:** Tamils launched struggles for recognition of Tamil as an official language and regional autonomy. Their demands were repeatedly denied, leading to demands for a separate Tamil Eelam and eventually a devastating civil war that lasted until 2009.

Source: *Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka, Chapter 1*

Explanation

- Examiners expect you to cover **all three types of majoritarian measures** — language, jobs/education, and religion — plus the consequences (alienation → civil war).
- Name the **1956 Act** specifically and link each measure to its impact on Tamils.
- End with the outcome (civil war, refugees, economic setback) to complete the chain of causation.
- 5 points for a 5-mark question is an ideal structure here.

Q20. § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka**[1]**

Two statements are given below. They are Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read both the statements carefully and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A) : There was civil war in Sri Lanka.

Reason (R) : An Act was passed in 1956 to secure dominance of Sinhala community on the government.

A Both (A) and (R) are correct and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

B Both (A) and (R) are correct, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).

C (A) is correct, but (R) is incorrect.

D (A) is incorrect, but (R) is correct.

Previously asked in: 2025 32/6/1 Q11

◆ Power-sharing

Civil War in Sri Lanka and Sinhala-Tamil Conflict

Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka

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Model Answer

Option A — Both (A) and (R) are correct and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

The 1956 Act made Sinhala the only official language, alienating Tamils, which eventually led to civil war.

Source: Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka, Chapter 1

Explanation

The Reason directly explains the Assertion: the majoritarian Act of 1956 was a key step that increased Tamil alienation, leading to conflict and ultimately civil war. So (R) correctly explains (A), making Option A the right choice. Remember — if both statements are true AND the reason logically causes/explains the assertion, choose A.

Q21. § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka

[1]

In Sri Lanka, which one of the following changes to the 1956 law gave rise to the possibility of civil war ?

- A Ensuring power sharing among all sections.
- B Declaring Sinhala as the official language.
- C Declaring Tamil as the official language.
- D Implementing a policy of preference for Sinhalese in government jobs.

Previously asked in: 2026 32/2/1 Q21

♦ Power-sharing Sri Lanka's Majoritarian Policies and the 1956 Sinhala-Only Act

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Model Answer

Answer: B — Declaring Sinhala as the official language.

In 1956, an Act was passed recognising Sinhala as the **only** official language, disregarding Tamil. This increased alienation among Sri Lankan Tamils, eventually leading to civil war.

Source: Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka, Chapter 1

Explanation

- The question asks specifically about the **1956 law**, so option B is the direct answer from the passage.
- Option D (preference for Sinhala in government jobs) was a later policy, not the 1956 Act itself — do not confuse the two.
- Options A and C are incorrect: the law did the opposite of A, and Tamil was *not* declared official.
- Examiners expect you to identify the correct option and briefly justify it with a factual statement from the chapter.

Q22. § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka

[1]

Which one of the following languages was declared as the official language of Sri Lanka by an Act passed in 1956 ?

- (a) Tamil
- (b) Sinhala
- (c) Hindi
- (d) English

Previously asked in: 2023 32/5/1 Q8

♦ Power-sharing Sinhala-Only Act 1956 and Sri Lanka's Official Language

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Model Answer

(b) Sinhala

In 1956, an Act was passed in Sri Lanka to recognise **Sinhala** as the only official language, disregarding Tamil.

Explanation

The passage from Chapter 1 directly states: *"In 1956, an Act was passed to recognise Sinhala as the only official language, thus disregarding Tamil."* This is a factual recall question — just identify the correct language from the source.

Q23. § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka**[1]**

Two statements are given below as Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read the statements and choose the correct option :

Assertion (A) : Sri Lanka adopted 'Tamil' as the official language of the State.

Reason (R) : The Govt. of Sri Lanka adopted a series of majoritarian measures.

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false but (R) is true.

Previously asked in: 2023 32/4/1 Q16

◆ Power-sharing

Majoritarian policies in Sri Lanka and ethnic conflict

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Model Answer

(d) (A) is false but (R) is true.

Sri Lanka adopted **Sinhala** (not Tamil) as the only official language in 1956, disregarding Tamil. However, the Government of Sri Lanka did adopt majoritarian measures to establish Sinhala supremacy, so (R) is correct.

Source: *Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka, Chapter 1*

Explanation

The key fact to remember: the 1956 Act made **Sinhala** the only official language — Tamil was *disregarded*, not recognised. Assertion (A) swaps the two languages, making it false. Reason (R) is accurate — the Sri Lankan government did adopt majoritarian measures. This is a classic "fact-swap" trap in Assertion-Reason questions; always verify each statement carefully against the textbook.

Q24. § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka**[2]**

Why did the feeling of alienation increase among the Sri Lankan Tamils in 1956 ? Explain.

Previously asked in: 2023 32/2/1 Q23

◆ Power-sharing

Majoritarian Policies and Tamil Alienation in Sri Lanka

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Model Answer

In 1956, an Act was passed recognising **Sinhala as the only official language**, thus disregarding Tamil. This made Sri Lankan Tamils feel that the government denied them equal political rights and discriminated against them in jobs and educational opportunities. They felt none of the major parties was sensitive to their language and culture.

Source: *Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka, Chapter 1*

Explanation

The examiner wants you to identify the specific 1956 event (the Sinhala-only Act) and link it directly to Tamil alienation. Two points are needed for 2 marks: (1) the Act making Sinhala the sole official language, and (2) the resulting feeling among Tamils of discrimination/denial of rights. Avoid writing about later events like the civil war — stay focused on 1956.

Q25. § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka**[1]**

Which of the following group is in majority in Sri Lanka?

- A Tamil-speakers
- B Sinhala-speakers
- C Telugu-speakers
- D English-speakers

Previously asked in: 2025 32/3/1 Q6

♦ Power-sharing

Ethnic composition and majoritarianism in Sri Lanka

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Model Answer

Answer: B — Sinhala-speakers

Sinhala-speakers are the majority community in Sri Lanka. Their leaders sought dominance and passed measures establishing Sinhala supremacy, including making Sinhala the only official language in 1956.

Source: Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka, Chapter 1

Explanation

The passage clearly states that "the leaders of the Sinhala community sought to secure dominance over government by virtue of their **majority**." This confirms Sinhala-speakers are the majority group. For MCQs, one line with the option and a brief justification from the text is sufficient. Avoid writing more than needed.

Q26. § Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka**[3]**

"The government measures gradually increased the feeling of alienation among the Sri Lankan Tamils." Explain the statement.

Previously asked in: 2025 32/2/1 Q27

◆ Power-sharing

Majoritarian policies and alienation of Sri Lankan Tamils

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Model Answer

The Sri Lankan government took several majoritarian steps that increased alienation among Tamils:

1. **Official Language Act (1956):** Sinhala was declared the only official language, disregarding Tamil entirely.
2. **Preferential Policies:** Sinhala applicants were favoured for university admissions and government jobs, reducing Tamil opportunities.
3. **Constitutional Provisions:** The constitution directed the state to protect and foster Buddhism, sidelining Tamil religious identity.

These consecutive measures made Tamils feel that the government denied them equal political rights, discriminated against them in education and employment, and ignored their cultural interests, deepening the sense of alienation.

Source: *Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka, Chapter 1*

Explanation

- The question asks you to **explain**, so listing 3 distinct government measures with a brief impact each is the ideal approach for 3 marks.
- Each measure = approximately 1 mark. End with a concluding line linking the measures to alienation.
- Avoid adding information about civil war or Tamil Eelam unless asked — that goes beyond what this question requires.
- Keywords to include: *Sinhala, official language, preferential policies, Buddhism, alienation.*

Q27. § Accommodation in Belgium**[1]**

Which of the following was the primary objective of Belgium to form the separate government in Brussels ?

- (a) Promoting cultural events.
- (b) Managing international relations.
- (c) Enforcing local laws.
- (d) Ensuring linguistic accommodation.

Previously asked in: 2024 32/1/1 Q11

◆ Power-sharing

Belgium's Power-Sharing Model and the Community Government in Brussels

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Model Answer**(d) Ensuring linguistic accommodation.**

Brussels formed a separate government to give equal representation to both Dutch and French-speaking communities, ensuring linguistic accommodation.

Source: *Accommodation in Belgium*, Chapter 1

Explanation

The passage clearly states that Brussels needed a separate government where **both communities have equal representation** — this was to accommodate the linguistic conflict between Dutch and French speakers in the capital. Options (a), (b), and (c) are not mentioned in the context of forming Brussels' separate government.

Q28. § Accommodation in Belgium**[1]**

There are two statements given as Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read both the statements and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A) : Belgium amended their constitution four times.

Reason (R) : Amendments were to enable everyone to live together in the same country.

- (a) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of the Assertion (A).
- (b) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, but Reason (R) is not the correct explanation of the Assertion (A).
- (c) Assertion (A) is true, but Reason (R) is false.
- (d) Assertion (A) is false, but Reason (R) is true.

Previously asked in: 2023 32/2/1 Q8

◆ Power-sharing

Belgium's Constitutional Amendments and Power-Sharing Model

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Model Answer**(a) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of the Assertion (A).**

Belgium amended their constitution four times (1970–1993) specifically to work out arrangements to enable everyone to live together within the same country.

Explanation

The passage directly states: "they amended their constitution **four times** so as to work out an arrangement that would enable **everyone to live together** within the same country." Both statements are factually correct, and R directly explains why A happened — making (a) the right choice.

Q29. § Accommodation in Belgium**[1]**

Which one of the following organisations has its headquarter in Brussels ?

- A United Nations Organisation
- B European Union
- C Non-Alignment Movement
- D South Asian Association for Regional Co-operation

Previously asked in: 2025 32/2/1 Q12

♦ Power-sharing

Belgium and Power-Sharing – Brussels as headquarters of international organisations

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Model Answer

Answer: (B) European Union

The passage states: *"When many countries of Europe came together to form the European Union, Brussels was chosen as its headquarters."*

Source: Accommodation in Belgium, Chapter 1

Explanation

The passage directly mentions Brussels as the headquarters of the European Union. For MCQ questions, always look for the exact fact in the source passage. The other options — UNO (New York), NAM (no permanent HQ), and SAARC (Kathmandu) — are not mentioned in connection with Brussels.

Q30. § Overview § Why power sharing is desirable? § Forms of power-sharing**[1]**

What role do 'checks and balances' play in a democratic country ? Choose the most suitable option from the following.

- (a) To establish a direct form of government without representatives.
- (b) To create a separation of powers to prevent from authoritarianism.
- (c) To prevent any change to the Constitution.
- (d) To ensure absolute power for one branch of government.

Previously asked in: 2024 32/1/1 Q13

♦ Power-sharing

Checks and Balances in Democracy

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Model Answer

(b) To create a separation of powers to prevent from authoritarianism.

Checks and balances ensure that the legislature, executive, and judiciary each limit the others' powers, so no single organ exercises unlimited authority.

Source: *Forms of power-sharing*, Chapter 1

Explanation

The passage explicitly states: "Each organ checks the others. This results in a balance of power among various institutions... This arrangement is called a system of checks and balances." Option (b) is the only choice that correctly reflects this idea. Options (a), (c), and (d) contradict the democratic principle of distributed power described in the chapter.

Q31. § Overview

[5]

"Power sharing increases trust between different groups." Support the statement.

Previously asked in: 2025 32/6/1 Q33(b)

◆ Power-sharing

Power Sharing and Trust-Building Among Social Groups

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Model Answer

Power sharing increases trust between different groups because it ensures that no single group can dominate others. The following points support this statement:

1. **Reduces conflict:** Power sharing reduces the possibility of conflict between social groups. Social conflict often leads to violence and political instability, so sharing power ensures political stability and order.
1. **Prevents majoritarianism:** Imposing the will of the majority over minorities undermines national unity in the long run. Power sharing prevents such tyranny and makes minorities feel secure.
1. **Promotes participation:** People have a right to be consulted on how they are governed. When citizens participate, they acquire a stake in the system, building trust in the government.
1. **Accommodates diversity:** Power sharing gives space to diverse social, religious, and linguistic groups in government, preventing alienation and fostering mutual respect.
1. **Spirit of democracy:** Power sharing is the very spirit of democracy — a legitimate government is one where all groups feel represented and heard.

Source: Chapter 1 — Why Power Sharing is Desirable; Forms of Power-Sharing

Explanation

- The question asks you to **support** the statement, so write in favour of power sharing — no need to present counter-arguments.
- Examiners look for **prudential reasons** (reduces conflict, ensures stability) and **moral reasons** (right to participation, legitimacy) from the textbook.
- Use textbook language like "tyranny of majority," "political instability," "accommodates diversity," and "spirit of democracy" — these fetch marks.
- Five points map neatly to 5 marks; keep each point one or two lines.

Q32. § Overview § Forms of power-sharing**[3]**

Evaluate the system of 'Checks and Balances' in the horizontal distribution of power in India.

Previously asked in: 2025 32/5/1 Q28

◆ Power-sharing

Checks and Balances in Horizontal Distribution of Power

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Model Answer

In India, horizontal distribution of power refers to the division of power among the three organs of government — Legislature, Executive, and Judiciary — at the same level.

The system of **Checks and Balances** ensures no single organ becomes too powerful:

- The **Legislature** makes laws, but the **Judiciary** can declare them unconstitutional.
- The **Executive** implements laws but is accountable to the Legislature.
- The **Judiciary** is independent and can review actions of both Legislature and Executive.

This prevents misuse of power and upholds the rule of law in a democracy.

Explanation

The examiner expects students to:

1. Define horizontal distribution briefly.
2. Name all three organs — Legislature, Executive, Judiciary.
3. Give **specific examples** of how each checks the other (this earns the marks).
4. Conclude with its importance (prevents concentration of power).

Key point: The source passages focus on federalism/decentralisation, but this question draws from Chapter 1 of Political Science (*Power Sharing*). Answer from standard NCERT knowledge on this topic. Keep the answer tight — three clear points with examples is sufficient for 3 marks.

Q33. § Overview

[5]

Compare the Belgian model and the Sri Lankan model of power sharing.

Previously asked in: 2026 32/2/1 Q26(a)

◆ Power-sharing

Belgian Model of Power Sharing

Majoritarianism vs. Accommodation in Power Sharing

Sri Lankan Model of Power Sharing

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Model Answer**Belgian Model vs Sri Lankan Model of Power Sharing:**

| Basis | Belgium | Sri Lanka |

|-----|-----|-----|

| Approach | Accommodative; power shared among communities | Majoritarian; Sinhala-speaking majority imposed dominance |

| Constitutional Change | Shifted from unitary to federal system (1993); regional governments given constitutional powers | Remained a unitary system; national government retains all powers |

| Minority Treatment | French-speaking minority given equal representation; community governments recognised | Tamil minority's language and interests ignored; Sinhala made official language |

| Outcome | Power-sharing prevented division of country on linguistic lines | Policies led to civil conflict and alienation of Tamil community |

| Lesson | Shows how accommodation and sharing can maintain unity | Shows how majoritarianism creates instability and demands for federalism |

The Belgian model is a **positive example** of power-sharing through negotiation, while the Sri Lankan model is a **negative example** showing how denial of power-sharing causes conflict.

Source: Chapter 1 – Power Sharing; Chapter 2 – Federalism

Explanation

- Examiners expect a **direct comparison** — either in a table (preferred for clarity) or parallel paragraphs.
- Key points to hit: Belgium → federal shift, accommodation, linguistic balance; Sri Lanka → unitary, Sinhala dominance, Tamil alienation, civil conflict.
- Mention the **1993 constitutional change** in Belgium and the **outcome** in each case (unity preserved vs. conflict) for full marks.
- Avoid writing only about one country; both must be covered equally.

Q34. § Forms of power-sharing**[1]**

Consider the following statements on Power Sharing and choose the correct option :

- (I) Majoritarianism is the real spirit of democracy.
- (II) It creates balance and harmony in different groups.
- (III) It reduces the possibility of conflict among social groups.
- (IV) Power sharing is the essence of democracy.

- (a) I, II and III
- (b) II, III and IV
- (c) I, III and IV
- (d) I, II and IV

Previously asked in: 2023 32/4/1 Q15

♦ Power-sharing

Importance and Spirit of Power Sharing

Majoritarianism vs Power Sharing

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Model Answer**(b) II, III and IV**

Statement I is incorrect — majoritarianism undermines democracy. Statements II, III, and IV correctly describe power sharing: it creates balance, reduces conflict, and is the essence of democracy.

Explanation

The source passage ("Why power sharing is desirable?") states: "power sharing is good because it helps to **reduce the possibility of conflict** between social groups" (Statement III) and "Power sharing is the **very spirit of democracy**" (Statement IV). It also implies balance and harmony among groups (Statement II). Majoritarianism is explicitly criticised — "Imposing the will of majority community over others... undermines the unity of the nation" — so Statement I is **false**. Eliminate any option containing I.

Q35. § Overview § Forms of power-sharing

[4]

Power Sharing

Power is shared among different organs of government, such as the legislature, executive and judiciary. Let us call this horizontal distribution of power because it allows different organs of government placed at the same level to exercise different powers. Such a separation ensures that none of the organs can exercise unlimited power. Each organ checks the others. This results in a balance of power among various institutions. Last year, we studied that in a democracy, even though ministers and government officials exercise power, they are responsible to the Parliament or State Assemblies. Similarly, although judges are appointed by the executive, they can check the functioning of executive or laws made by the legislatures. This arrangement is called a system of checks and balances.

Read the given source carefully and answer the questions that follow :

- 28.1** Explain the term 'Balance of Power'. [1]
28.2 Why is the judiciary considered independent in a democracy ? [1]
28.3 How is power shared among different organs of government ? [2]

Previously asked in: 2026 32/4/1 Q28

◆ Power-sharing Horizontal distribution of power among organs of government

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Model Answer

- 28.1** Balance of Power means a situation where each organ of government checks the others, ensuring no single organ exercises unlimited power, thus maintaining equilibrium among institutions.
- 28.2** Although judges are appointed by the executive, they can independently check the functioning of the executive and review laws made by the legislature. This freedom makes the judiciary independent.
- 28.3** Power is shared among the legislature, executive, and judiciary through **horizontal distribution of power**. Each organ operates at the same level but exercises different powers. No organ can exercise unlimited power as each checks the others — for example, ministers are responsible to Parliament, and judges can review executive actions. This is called a **system of checks and balances**.

Source: *Power Sharing, Horizontal Distribution of Power*

Explanation

- **28.1** is 1 mark — one crisp line defining Balance of Power directly from the passage.
- **28.2** is 1 mark — focus on the key idea: appointed by executive yet can check it = independence.
- **28.3** is 2 marks — mention horizontal distribution, all three organs, "no unlimited power," and checks and balances. Examiners look for these specific terms from the passage, so use them explicitly.

Q36. § Overview § Why power sharing is desirable? § Forms of power-sharing

[1]

Consider the following statements on Power sharing and choose the correct option.

- I. Imposing the will of majority community over others.
- II. It helps in reducing the possibility of conflict between the social groups.
- III. Power sharing is a good way to ensure the stability of political order.
- IV. It brings socio-political opposition among parties.

- (A) I and III
- (B) II and III
- (C) I and IV
- (D) I and II

Previously asked in: 2023 32/6/1 Q15

♦ Power-sharing Reasons for Power Sharing

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Model Answer

(B) II and III

Statements II and III are correct — power sharing reduces the possibility of conflict between social groups and ensures the stability of political order. Statement I describes majoritarianism (undesirable), and Statement IV is incorrect as power sharing reduces, not brings, socio-political opposition.

Explanation

The textbook (*Why power sharing is desirable?*, Chapter 1) clearly states: "power sharing helps to reduce the possibility of conflict between social groups" and "power sharing is a good way to ensure the stability of political order." Statement I describes what power sharing *opposes* (imposing majority will), and Statement IV contradicts the text entirely. Examiners expect students to identify the two *correct* prudential reasons for power sharing.

Q37. § Overview § Forms of power-sharing**[4]****Forms of power sharing**

The idea of power sharing has emerged in opposition to the notions of undivided political power. For a long time, it was believed that all power of a government must reside in one person or group of persons located at one place. It was felt that if the power to decide is dispersed, it would not be possible to take quick decisions and to enforce them. But these notions have changed with the emergence of democracy. One basic principle of democracy is that people are the source of all political power. In a democracy, people rule themselves through institutions of self-government. In a good democratic government, due respect is given to diverse groups and views that exist in a society. Everyone has a voice in the shaping of public policies. Therefore, it follows that in a democracy, political power should be distributed among as many citizens as possible.

Read the given source carefully and answer the questions that follow :

- (27.1)** Why should all the powers of the government not be in the hands of one person ? [1]
(27.2) Why is power sharing necessary ? [1]
(27.3) How does governing through institutions of self-government strengthen democracy ? Explain. [2]

Previously asked in: 2026 32/3/1 Q27

♦ **Power-sharing** Forms of Power Sharing Institutions of Self-Government and Democracy Need and Importance of Power Sharing

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Model Answer

- (27.1)** If all power is concentrated in one person, quick decisions may be taken but diverse groups and views in society get no voice, which is against the basic principles of democracy.
(27.2) Power sharing is necessary because people are the source of all political power in a democracy. Distributing power among as many citizens as possible ensures everyone has a voice in shaping public policies.
(27.3) When people rule themselves through institutions of self-government, it ensures that diverse groups and views in society receive due respect. Every citizen gets a voice in shaping public policies. This prevents concentration of power in one place and makes governance more inclusive and representative, thereby strengthening democracy.

Source: Chapter 1 – Power Sharing, Forms of Power Sharing

Explanation

- **27.1** is 1 mark — one line linking concentrated power to lack of voice/democratic deficit.
- **27.2** is 1 mark — quote the core principle (people = source of power) and link to distribution.
- **27.3** is 2 marks — needs two connected points: (i) respect for diverse groups/views, and (ii) voice in public policy-making. Examiners look for both ideas from the passage. Don't add outside knowledge; stick to the extract.

Q38. § Overview § Why power sharing is desirable? § Forms of power-sharing**[1]**

Read the arguments given in the favour of power sharing and choose the correct option.

- I. Reduces the likelihood of bias.
- II. Barricades the decision-making process.
- III. Accommodates diversities.
- IV. Increases the participation of people in power.

- (A) Only I, II and III are correct.
- (B) Only II, III and IV are correct.
- (C) Only I, III and IV are correct.
- (D) Only I, II and IV are correct.

Previously asked in: 2024 32/4/1 Q8

♦ **Power-sharing** Arguments in favour of power sharing

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Model Answer

(C) Only I, III and IV are correct.

Statement II is incorrect because power sharing does **not** barricade (delay/block) decision-making as an argument *in favour* of it — that is an argument *against* it.

Explanation

The question tests knowledge of arguments **in favour** of power sharing. Statement II ("Barricades the decision-making process") is actually a criticism/argument **against** power sharing (opponents argue it slows decisions). Statements I, III, and IV — reducing bias, accommodating diversities, and increasing people's participation — are all standard prudential/moral reasons given in favour of power sharing, as discussed in Chapter 1.

Q39. § Overview § Why power sharing is desirable? § Forms of power-sharing**[2]**

How is horizontal power sharing different from vertical ? Explain.

Previously asked in: 2024 32/2/1 Q22

♦ **Power-sharing** Forms of Power Sharing Horizontal Power Sharing Vertical Power Sharing

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Model Answer

Horizontal power sharing means power is shared among different organs at the **same level** — legislature, executive, and judiciary. Each organ checks the others (system of checks and balances), so no single organ has unlimited power.

Vertical power sharing means power is divided among governments at **different levels** — Central, State, and Local governments. Higher and lower levels of government share power, as in India's federal system.

Source: Forms of Power-Sharing, Chapter 1

Explanation

The examiner expects you to clearly contrast the two types using the key terms: **same level** (horizontal) and **different levels** (vertical). Give one example for each — legislature/executive/judiciary for horizontal; Central/State/Local for vertical. Avoid writing long explanations; two crisp points with examples are enough for 2 marks.

Q40. § Overview § Forms of power-sharing

[4]

Forms of Power-sharing

The idea of power-sharing has emerged in opposition to the notions of undivided political power. For a long time, it was believed that all power of a government must reside in one person or group of persons located at one place. It was felt that if the power to decide is dispersed, it would not be possible to take quick decisions and to enforce them. But these notions have changed with the emergence of democracy. One basic principle of democracy is that people are the source of all political power. In a democracy, people rule themselves through institutions of self-government. In a good democratic government, due respect is given to diverse groups and views that exist in a society. Everyone has a voice in the shaping of public policies. Therefore, it follows that in a democracy, political power should be distributed among as many citizens as possible.

Read the given source carefully and answer the questions that follow :

- 28.1** How does power sharing promote stability of political order ? [1]
28.2 How are pressure groups part of the power sharing mechanism ? [1]
28.3 How does power sharing contribute to the spirit of democracy ? [2]

Previously asked in: 2026 32/5/1 Q28

◆ **Power-sharing** Forms of Power-sharing Power-sharing and stability of political order Power-sharing and the spirit of democracy
 Pressure groups as part of power-sharing mechanism

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Model Answer

(28.1) Power-sharing promotes stability by reducing the risk of conflict. When power is shared among diverse groups, no single group feels excluded, which reduces social tensions and prevents political instability.

(28.2) Pressure groups represent the interests of specific sections of society. By influencing government decisions and policies from outside the formal structure, they ensure that power is not concentrated in one place, making them part of the power-sharing mechanism.

(28.3) Power-sharing is the very spirit of democracy because people are the source of all political power. It gives due respect to diverse groups and ensures everyone has a voice in shaping public policies. Distributing power among as many citizens as possible reflects the democratic principle of self-governance and prevents authoritarian concentration of power.

Source: Chapter 1 – Power Sharing, Political Science (Democratic Politics II)

Explanation

- **28.1** focuses on the "prudential reason" for power-sharing — stability and conflict reduction. One crisp line is enough for 1 mark.
- **28.2** is slightly beyond the passage (pressure groups are from a different section of the chapter), so use your textbook knowledge. Examiners expect you to link pressure groups to the idea of dispersed power.
- **28.3** requires 2 marks, so give 2 clear points: (i) people as the source of power / self-governance, and (ii) respect for diversity / voice in policy. Always tie back to the passage for source-based questions.

Q41.

[1]

Look at the given cartoon carefully and answer the question that follow :
Which of the following concepts is best illustrated in the cartoon ?

- A Inclusive economic growth amongst nations
- B Stagnation of economic development amongst nations
- C Uneven distribution of wealth amongst nations
- D Balanced economic growth amongst nations

Previously asked in: 2026 32/5/1 Q21

♦ Power-sharing

Cartoon-based illustration of power-sharing concepts

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Model Answer

Option C: Uneven distribution of wealth amongst nations

The cartoon depicts disparity between rich and poor nations, which best illustrates the concept of uneven distribution of wealth amongst nations.

Explanation

The cartoon visually shows the gap between wealthy and poor nations. Option A (inclusive growth) and D (balanced growth) are opposites of what is shown. Option B (stagnation) refers to no growth, not disparity. Examiners expect students to read the visual carefully and match it to the correct economic concept. The keyword in the cartoon description is "disparity," which directly points to **uneven distribution**.

Q42. § Overview § Forms of power-sharing

[4]

POWER SHARING

Power sharing arrangements can also be seen in the way political parties, pressure groups and movements control or influence those in power. In a democracy, the citizens must have freedom to choose among various contenders for power. In contemporary democracies, this takes the form of competition among different parties. Such competition ensures that power does not remain in one hand. In the long run, power is shared among different political parties that represent different ideologies and social groups. Sometimes this kind of sharing can be direct, when two or more parties form an alliance to contest elections. If their alliance is elected, they form a coalition government and thus share power. In a democracy, we find interest groups, such as those of traders, businessmen, industrialists, farmers and industrial workers. They also will have a share in governmental power, either through participation in governmental committees or bringing influence on the decision-making process.

Read the given source carefully and answer the questions that follow :

- 28.1** How do pressure groups influence the government ? [1]
28.2 How do social groups benefit from power sharing ? [1]
28.3 Explain the contributions of citizens in the power sharing process. [2]

Previously asked in: 2026 32/1/1 Q28

◆ Power-sharing

Forms of power sharing among social groups

Role of pressure groups, parties and movements in power sharing

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Model Answer

28.1 Pressure groups influence the government by participating in governmental committees or by bringing influence on the decision-making process.

28.2 Political parties represent different ideologies and social groups. In the long run, power is shared among these parties, allowing various social groups to have a share in governmental power and benefit from power sharing arrangements.

28.3 In a democracy, citizens must have the freedom to choose among various contenders for power. This takes the form of competition among different political parties in contemporary democracies. By voting and choosing their representatives, citizens ensure that power does not remain in one hand. They also participate through interest groups (traders, farmers, workers, etc.) that influence governmental decisions.

Source: *Power Sharing, Class 10 Political Science (Democratic Politics II)*

Explanation

- **28.1** is 1 mark — one direct line from the passage is enough.
- **28.2** is 1 mark — link "parties representing social groups" to power sharing benefit; one line suffices.
- **28.3** is 2 marks — needs two distinct points: (i) freedom to choose/vote among competing parties, and (ii) competition ensures power doesn't concentrate. Mentioning interest groups adds depth. Examiners look for both points clearly stated. Always anchor answers in the passage for source-based questions.

Q43.**[1]**

Choose the appropriate option to fill in the blank :

- (A) Energy Minerals
- (B) Non-Metallic Minerals
- (C) Non-Ferrous Minerals
- (D) Precious Minerals

Previously asked in: 2026 32/1/1 Q13

♦ **Power-sharing**

Fill in the blank — Power-sharing concept

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Model Answer

(C) Non-Ferrous Minerals

Bauxite is a non-ferrous mineral (used to produce aluminium), so the blank middle box in the flowchart should read **Non-Ferrous Minerals**.

Source: Chapter 5 (Minerals and Energy Resources), Classification of Minerals

Explanation

The flowchart classifies minerals into three types: Ferrous (e.g., Nickel/Iron), **Non-Ferrous** (e.g., Bauxite/Aluminium), and Precious (e.g., Gold). Non-ferrous minerals do not contain iron. Bauxite is the ore of aluminium, making option (C) the only correct fit. Students often confuse non-ferrous with non-metallic — remember: non-ferrous minerals *are* metallic but lack iron content.